STATUTORY COMPLIANCE

South Africa CIPC Annual Return Compliance Checklist 2026

A step-by-step guide to avoiding deregistration and maintaining statutory good standing

PDF GUIDE · 1.2 MB · 2026 EDITION

Your Partner in Compliance, Research and Sustainable Impact

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South Africa (Nationwide Service)

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Every company and close corporation registered with the Companies and Intellectual Property Commission (CIPC) must file an Annual Return every year, within the prescribed period after its anniversary of incorporation. Missing this deadline is one of the most common reasons South African businesses are deregistered without ever realising it. This checklist walks you through the essentials so you know exactly where your business stands.

FILING WINDOW	RISK OF MISSING IT	APPLIES TO
Within 30 business days of anniversary date	Deregistration & loss of legal status	All Pty Ltd, NPC & CC entities

1. Confirm Your Filing Due Date

Your Annual Return due date is linked to your company's original registration (incorporation) date, not the tax year. Check your CIPC registration certificate or CoR14.3 for the exact anniversary date.

- Locate your registration date on your CIPC certificate
- Note that the filing window opens on the anniversary month, not the calendar year
- Set a recurring reminder at least 60 days before the anniversary

2. Documents & Details to Have Ready

- Company registration number and CIPC login credentials
- Confirmation of registered address (must be current)
- Director and shareholder details, including any recent changes
- Beneficial Ownership Register information (see Section 3)

Financial Accountability Supplement requirements, turnover-based document thresholds, and the exact CIPC portal navigation steps are covered in detail in the full version of this checklist.

3. Beneficial Ownership Reporting

Since the amendments to the Companies Act regulations, most entities must also declare their Beneficial Ownership register to CIPC, separately from the Annual Return itself. Getting the ownership percentages, control structures and supporting documentation right the first time avoids a rejected filing.

- Identify all natural persons with beneficial ownership or control
- Prepare percentage-of-ownership calculations for layered shareholding

Full guidance on complex ownership structures (trusts, holding companies, nominee shareholders) and the exact CIPC BO forms required is available through our compliance support service.

4. Common Reasons Filings Get Rejected

- Outdated registered address not matching CIPC records
- Director details not updated after a resignation or appointment
- Annual Return filed before outstanding prior-year returns are settled

5. After You File

Once submitted, keep your proof of filing (the CIPC reference and payment confirmation) for your records, in case of a compliance audit or bank due diligence request.

Don't risk deregistration.

SARE Projects Solutions handles CIPC Annual Returns, Beneficial Ownership filings and full compliance monitoring for businesses and NPOs across South Africa — so nothing falls through the cracks.

Send us your registration number and we'll confirm your filing status, free of charge.

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This checklist is provided for general guidance only and does not constitute legal or tax advice. Requirements may change; always confirm current requirements with CIPC or a registered compliance practitioner.